REVISION OF THE UN CHARTER

CHAPTER XVIII of the UN Charter contains provisions for the amendments of the Charter. Article 108 of the Charter states that Amendments to the present Charter shall come into force for all members of the United Nations when they have been adopted by a vote of two thirds of the members of the General Assembly and ratified in accordance with their respective constitutional processes by two-thirds of the members of the United Nations, including all the permanent members of the Security Council.

Article 109 states that:

1. A general conference of the members of the United Nations for the purpose of reviewing the present Charter may be held at a date and place to be fixed by a two-thirds vote of the members of the General Assembly and by a vote of any nine members of the Security Council. Each member of the United Nations shall have one vote in the conference.
2. Any alteration of the present Charter recommended by a two-thirds vote of the conference shall take effect when ratified in accordance with their respective constitutional processes by two-thirds of the members of the United Nations, including all the permanent members of the Security Council.
3. If such a conference has not been held before the tenth annual session of the General Assembly following the coming into force of the UN Charter, the proposal to call such a conference shall be placed on the agenda of that session of the General Assembly, and the conference shall be held if so decided by a majority vote of the members of the General Assembly and by a vote of any seven members of the Security Council.

Besides these formal procedures enunciated in the Charter, several informal and formal changes have been brought to fore, such as in 1965 when the number of non-permanent members was raised, thereby increasing the original membership of the Security Council from 11 to 15. Likewise, the composition of Economic and Social Council was also expanded from 18 to 27 in 1965. Changes can be brought about by non-implementation of the textual provisions as in